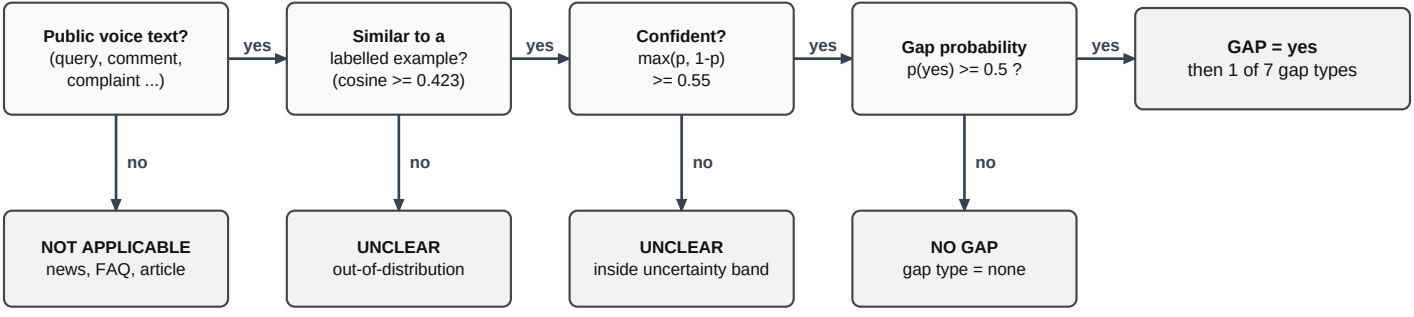Awareness-gap decision rules (service.py _gap)